

HOMONYMS

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A homonym is a word that has the same spelling or pronunciation as another word but has a different meaning.

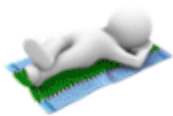
- Homonyms can be spelled the same (homographs) or sound the same (homophones) but their meanings vary depending on the context.

HOMOGRAPHS: Same spelling.
Pronunciation may be same or different.
Meaning is different.

Word	Example of first meaning	Example of second meaning
lead	Gold is denser than lead /lɛd/.	The mother duck will lead /li:d/ her ducklings around.
close	"Will you please close /klaʊz/ that door!"	The tiger was now so close /klaʊs/ that I could smell it...
wind	The wind /waɪnd/ howled through the woodlands.	Wind /waɪnd/ your watch.
minute	I will be there in a minute /'mɪnɪt/.	That is a very minute /maɪ'nu:t//maɪ'nju:t/ amount.

HOMOPHONES:

Different Spelling. Same Pronunciation.
Different Meaning.

 break	 brake	 whole	 hole	 see	 sea	$1+1=2$ sum	 some
 by	 buy	 I	 eye	 one	 won	 here	 hear
 cite	 site	 blew	 blue	 for	 four	 no	 know
 hour	 our	 sun	 son	 made	 maid	 not	 knot

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A homonym is a word that has the same spelling or pronunciation as another word but has a different meaning.

HOMONYMS

Words that sound the same but have different meanings.



Nail



Nail



Bat



Bat



Palm



Palm



Right



Right



Ring



Ring



Band



Band

1. The bat flew silently through the night sky. Meanwhile, the cricket player gripped his bat tightly, ready to hit the ball.

What does the word "bat" mean in the sentence?

- a) A sports item
- b) A flying mammal
- c) Both a and b
- d) None of the above

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2. The dog's bark was loud enough to wake the entire neighbourhood. At the same time, the tree's bark was rough and textured.

Which meaning of "bark" is NOT used in this passage?

- a) Dog's sound
- b) Tree covering
- c) To speak sharply
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3. She lost her wedding ring while listening to the ring of the old church bell.

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- b) A sound
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4. Please park your car in the shaded area nearby.
The kids ran and played in the park happily.
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5. He left early from the meeting. He made a left turn at the next traffic signal.

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6. Choose the sentence that uses a homonym of the underlined word.

He had to bear the heavy load.

- A) The polar bear lives in the Arctic.
- B) He could not bear the pain.
- C) She asked him to bear responsibility.
- D) They must bear in mind the risks.

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7. Choose the sentence that uses a homonym of the underlined word. (SSC-CGL '25)

Please close the window before leaving.

- a) He forgot to close the file before shutting down his laptop.
- b) I always close the curtains at night.
- c) Their bond grew close over the years.
- d) Make sure to close the back door.

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She will lead the singing at tonight's event.

- a) She will lead our group.
- b) We need to lead by example.
- c) The pipes are made of lead.
- d) The lead singer's performance was outstanding.

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*Explanation: "Lead" (material) is a homonym of "lead" (to guide), but the meaning differs: one is a **metal**, the other is an **action**.*

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He played the bass in the school orchestra.

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- b) She was feeling the bass coming from a nearby speaker.
- c) My friend plays the bass guitar.
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Explanation: "Bass" (related to music) and "bass" (fish) are homonyms with different pronunciations and meanings.

10. Choose the sentence that uses a homonym of the underlined word.

The soldiers were asked to desert their post.

- a) The traitor decided to desert his comrades.
- b) Many tried to desert the army during the war.
- c) The Sahara is the largest desert in the world.
- d) The thief attempted to desert the camp unnoticed.

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Explanation: "Desert" (abandon) has a homonym "desert" (arid region). Only option C has a different meaning.

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- b) bare
- c) the
- d) suspense

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- a) didn’t
- b) know
- c) weather
- d) meeting

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- a) didn’t
- b) know
- c) **weather** (whether)
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- b) principle
- c) concern
- d) safety

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b) principle (should be ‘principal’)

c) concern

d) safety

14. Choose the right homonym:

He gave me good _____ on how to prepare for exams.

- a) advise
- b) advice
- c) advize
- d) advisce

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The engineer visited the ----- for inspection.

- a) cite
- b) site
- c) sight
- d) certificate

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